

LESSON 121 (0.3 GROUND, 0.5 DUAL, and 0.5 SOLO)

Lesson Objective

The purpose of this lesson is for the student to conduct his/her first solo flight. The flight will increase the student's confidence and prepare him/her for future local and cross-country solo flights. Prior to the solo portion of this lesson, a dual flight is conducted to ensure the student is ready to solo under the current conditions.

Briefing

- Outline the objectives and completion standards of the lesson.
- Establish the student and instructor responsibilities.
- Review homework assigned in the previous lesson.
 - Review relevant airport diagrams with the student.
- Student questions.

References

- Airplane Flying Handbook. ([FAA-H-8083-3C](#))
 - Chapter 06 - Takeoffs and Departure Climbs.
 - Chapter 08 - Airport Traffic Patterns.
 - Chapter 09 - Approaches and Landings.
- Pilot's Handbook of Aeronautical Knowledge. ([FAA-H-8083-25B](#))
 - Chapter 14 - Airport Operations.

Lesson Content (Ground)

Preflight Inspection

- Ensure that the student conducted a thorough preflight inspection.

Local Solo Brief

- Brief the plan of action to the student:
 - The first part of the flight will be a dual flight.
 - The student must demonstrate that they can conduct at least three safe takeoffs, traffic patterns, and landings.
 - No instructor guidance.
 - All landings must be full stop taxi backs.
 - Have the student take out their airport diagram.
 - Based on the runways in use, ask the student about what taxiways they should expect, radio calls, procedures, runway incursion avoidance, etc.
 - If the instructor will be getting dropped off at the north side, brief the student about the procedure.
 - Exit the runway at M or Q.
 - Enter the North t-hangar ramp at M or K1.
 - If entering at M, make the first right after entering the ramp.

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- If entering at K1, make the first left after entering the ramp.
- Once exiting the aircraft, the student must call ground control to request taxi before blocking the M or K1 entry/exit.
- Once the solo is completed, the student needs to request a full stop at the North t-hangars and enter as briefed above.
- For guidance, refer to the airport diagram at the bottom of this lesson plan.
- The second part of the flight will be a solo flight.
 - As aforementioned, all landings must be full stop taxi backs.
 - The student should mention “student pilot solo” on initial contact with Melbourne ground and Melbourne tower.
 - Monitor the student’s radio calls through the portable radio.
 - Track the student’s pattern visually if able or through an app (Flightradar24, FlightAware, etc.)

Go/No-Go Decision

- The student must make a go/no-go decision depending on:
 - Personal minimums.
 - FIT minimums.
 - Aircraft.
 - Airspace.
- Review the students planning with a focus on:
 - Weather, weight and balance, performance, flight planning, and fuel calculations.
 - NOTAMs, TFRs, FIFs, aircraft documents, and personal documents.
 - Equipment requirements (e.g. flashlight, fuel card, drinking water, view-limiting devices, life jackets, fly away kit, survival kit, etc.)
 - FRAT/TEM/safety considerations for the flight.
- While this is represented by one line item prior to departure, the go/ no-go decision is continuous and should be a consideration even once airborne.

Lesson Content (Dual)

Go-Around/Rejected Landing

- Have the student conduct a go-around during one of the traffic patterns.
- Ensure that the correct procedure is conducted.

Traffic Pattern Procedures

- The student will be in charge of all of the radio calls with tower and ground.
 - Emphasize the use of saying “say again” if the instructions are not clear.
 - Emphasize the use of saying “unable” if the instructions are not safe or cannot be followed.
- Traffic patterns are to be completed by the student without instructor guidance.

Normal and Crosswind Landings

- Verify correct airspeeds.

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- Verify timing of the round out and the flare.
- At least one main gear should be on the centerline.
- Longitudinal axis of the airplane must be aligned with the runway, no side-loaded landings.

Power Off Landing

- While on the downwind, bring the power to idle.
- Ensure that the student pitches for 73 knots.
- Guide the student through when to turn base/final depending on the wind (if needed).
- The student must be able to land on the first third of the runway.

Postflight Procedures

- Ensure that the student conducts a thorough postflight inspection.

Lesson Content (Solo)**Normal and Crosswind Takeoffs**

- Student pilot solo.

Traffic Patterns

- Student pilot solo.

Normal and Crosswind Landings

- Student pilot solo.

Postflight Procedures

- Student pilot solo.
- Ring the bell!

Post-Brief

- Student self-critique.
- Instructor critique.
- Questions from the student.
- Lesson grading.
- Logbook completion.
- Schedule the next lesson.
- Preview the next lesson → 122.

Completion Standards

This lesson is complete when the student is able to:

1. When dual, complete at least three stop and go or full stop normal/crosswind takeoffs and landings without instructor guidance.
2. When solo, execute a local solo in accordance with all FIT, FAA and local procedures and regulations.